

SOC Analyst Career Prep Summary

User Career Focus

User is preparing for entry-level cybersecurity jobs, with a preference for SOC Analyst roles. Remote roles are preferred, but in-person roles around Stamford, CT are acceptable. User is open to internships, part-time, contract, or full-time positions, especially in healthcare, finance, entertainment, and government.

Top Cybersecurity Incidents to Know

- SolarWinds (2020)
- Colonial Pipeline (2021)
- Microsoft Exchange / Hafnium (2021)
- MOVEit (2023)
- Capital One (2019)
- MGM Resorts (2023)
- JBS Foods (2021)

These incidents are useful to discuss in interviews.

Key Concepts Explained

- Zero-day: A vulnerability with no known patch.
- MFA Fatigue: Attackers spam users with MFA prompts to trick approval.
- Supply Chain Attack: Targeting vendors to reach the final victim.
- Ransomware / Double Extortion: Files encrypted plus threats to leak data.
- Lateral Movement: Attackers move within networks after initial access.
- Cloud Misconfiguration: Incorrect settings lead to exposure.

Best Cybersecurity Jobs for Asperger's Syndrome (Ranked)

1. Security Automation Engineer
2. Digital Forensics Analyst
3. Threat Intelligence Researcher
4. SOC Analyst
5. Compliance / GRC Analyst
6. Vulnerability Researcher / Exploit Developer

SOC Analyst Career Path

A SOC Analyst role is one of the best ways to start in cybersecurity. You monitor alerts, analyze logs, and respond to incidents. It can lead to roles like Threat Intelligence Researcher, DFIR, or Security Engineer.

SOC Analyst Learning Roadmap (90-120 Days)

1. Learn Networking and SOC Basics (TryHackMe, Professor Messer)
2. Learn Tools (Splunk, Wireshark, MITRE ATT&CK)
3. Practice Alert Triage, Documentation, and Interviewing
4. Use Blue Team Level Up, IBM Cybersecurity Analyst course, and CyberDefenders challenges

SOC Analyst: Day in the Life

Morning alert reviews, triage tasks, SIEM/EDR tool usage, documentation, escalation, and sometimes incident response. Repetitive at Tier 1 but excellent for skill-building. Includes constant communication and decision-making.